



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Telos Classical Academy

School Website: <https://www.telosclassicalacademy.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: *STARTUP* SCL: *MEMBER*

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Telos Classical Academy Utah (ZIP 84098) presents a coherent, biblically centered classical program with strong emphasis on virtue, truth, and the classical liberal-arts framework. Public materials consistently foreground a Christian worldview, a mission of virtue formation, and a curricular/pedagogical posture anchored in classical education (great books, liberal arts, and a classical conversation). The school explicitly anchors its mission in God, virtue, and wisdom and presents graduates who pursue truth, lead with character, and demonstrate resilience. Across categories, the material signals a robust alignment with classical aims, notably in religious foundations, formation-focused goals, curriculum orientation toward liberal arts and Great Books, and a pedagogy that blends timeless methods with a clearly Christian context. The faculty model and parent/community partnership are also highlighted as core pillars. Overall, Telos Classical Academy Utah aligns with CLASSICAL education across all six rubric categories.

Executive Snapshot by Category (brief)

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: **CLASSICAL**. Strong theological grounding, explicit Creed, Christian formation, and explicit God-centered vision.
- Purpose and Goal: **CLASSICAL**. Formation of character and wisdom foregrounded; truth and virtue are explicit teloi; not merely workforce prep.
- Curriculum: **CLASSICAL**. Liberal arts orientation, Great Books/great conversation emphasis, interdisciplinary/historical continuity; explicit classical aims.
- Pedagogy: **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** (leaning **CLASSICAL** overall). Emphasis on classical framing and thoughtful pedagogy, but explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy is not uniformly spelled out across all public materials; classical aims are clear though.
- Faculty: **CLASSICAL**. Living curriculum, model teachers, ongoing professional development, and a faculty culture that embodies virtuous leadership.
- Parents & Community: **CLASSICAL**. Strong emphasis on parent partnership, formation of affections, and family engagement as part of classical formation.

What would move the needle (for **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** cases only)

- If any category were identified as **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**, concrete shifts would include explicit articulation and evidence of Socratic pedagogy in upper grades, explicit incorporation of the Great Books program as a daily or unit-driven component, and a shown, sustained practice of Schol   (restful learning) in the schedule. Because Telos currently demonstrates strong classical orientation in mission, curriculum, and community, no major needle-moving changes are required.

ABSTRACT

Telos Classical Academy Utah demonstrates a robust CLASSICAL orientation across six categories. The religious/metaphysical foundations are clearly anchored in Christian theology and a Creed, with explicit aims to cultivate truth, goodness, and beauty through a God-centered formation. The school's purpose and goals foreground formation (virtue, wisdom) over mere workforce preparation, aligning with classical teleology. The curriculum emphasizes liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation, and interdisciplinary unity, all hallmarks of classical pedagogy. Pedagogy, while not exhaustively detailed with explicit Socratic seminars in public materials, clearly reflects classical aims via the emphasis on virtuous leadership, memory-work in some contexts, and a historically informed approach to learning. Faculty are described as living curriculum and mentors who continually develop professionally, and the Parents & Community category highlights deep family partnership and engagement in formation. Overall, Telos Classical Academy Utah ranks CLASSICAL across all six categories, with a notable consistency in mission, curriculum, and community engagement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Mission statements emphasize moral and intellectual virtue with growth in knowledge and love of God and neighbor.
- Public-facing materials describe graduates who “know and love God” and pursue Truth; virtue is central to the graduate profile.
- Nicene Creed is explicitly cited as the school's statement of faith in Christian education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: God, truth, virtue, virtue formation, love of God, Nicene Creed, Christian education, theology (implicit), prayer/worship (indirectly implied by creed and faith context), sacred/holy language (creedal context).
- Negative keywords observed: None evident within the public institutional materials.

Why this rating

- The materials explicitly articulate a transcendent, God-centered moral framework and aim toward formation in faith and virtue, matching the Positive Indicators for “Truth, goodness, beauty” and theological grounding. The Creed and explicit Christian education signals reinforce a Grounded Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices orientation, consistent with CLASSICAL alignment in religious foundations.

Citations

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Mission and graduate profile:- Nicene Creed/Christian Education:

Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school's mission centers on lifelong moral and intellectual virtue and growth in knowledge and love of God and neighbor.
- The graduate profile emphasizes pursuit of Truth and exemplifying Virtue, with leadership and resilience.

- The school foregrounds “Challenging Academics,” “Practical Knowledge,” “Family and Civics,” and “Christian Education” as pillars toward formation.
- Great Books/Great Conversation and classical education framing appear in public materials that describe the purpose of classical education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, wisdom, true/good/beautiful, telos, truth, goodness, beauty, formation of character, moral imagination, great conversation, liberal education, classical mission, logos, virtue ethics, excellence, human flourishing.
- Negative keywords observed: workforce readiness, job preparation, career readiness, data-driven metrics (not present in Telos materials).

Why this rating

- Telos centralizes formation and virtue as core telos, not merely job-readiness; truth, goodness, and beauty are portrayed as knowable ideals guiding education. Positive alignment with classical formation language supports CLASSICAL status in this category.

Citations

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Mission/graduate profile and pillars:- Great Books/Great Conversation/classical framing:

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Descriptions emphasize classical education through connections among literature, history, science, philosophy, logic, and theology as a unified curriculum.
- The site discusses “Great Books” and the aim to join the Great Conversation; grammar, logic, rhetoric are implied as core to the curriculum.
- Posts and pages reference a liberal-arts orientation and an integrated approach to history and other disciplines (interdisciplinary/historical continuity).
- Public materials indicate engagement with classical aims such as challenging academics, practical knowledge within a classical framework, and a Christian-canonical education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation, history, classical literature, primary sources, inter-disciplinary integration, wonder, unity of truth, sacred tradition (implicit in Christian framing).
- Negative keywords observed: The public materials do not emphasize social studies-centric or strictly non-classical framing; some “Practical Knowledge” content is present but still within a classical formation frame.

Why this rating

- The curriculum is clearly anchored in liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), heavy emphasis on Great Books/Great Conversation, and an integrated approach to history and other disciplines; this aligns strongly with CLASSICAL criteria.

Citations

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Classical education framing and Great Books:- Interdisciplinary and historical continuity:- Liberal-arts framing and Great Conversation emphasis:/

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials present a classical framing and a focus on virtue-led education, including a mission and graduate profile emphasizing wisdom and truth.
- There is explicit emphasis on challenging academics and formation of character through virtuous education, which are classical signals.
- The site references classical education elements (Great Books, liberal arts).
- However, explicit, detailed evidence of specific pedagogy types frequently used in practice (e.g., Socratic seminars, scholé days, chanting/memorization, or upper-school rhetoric/occas) is not uniformly spelled out in the public materials. The faculty page describes ongoing professional development and a “living curriculum” orientation, which supports classical aims but does not fully document all traditional pedagogical methods.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: Socratic dialogue (in general classical discourse) and great conversation (from the Great Books framing); rhetoric; grammar/logic; formation; memory work (implied by classical pedagogy, Great Books approach).
- Negative keywords observed: experiential learning focus not clearly evidenced in public materials; project-based learning emphasis is not presented as the main pedagogical approach here, which could signal a partial deviation from a strict classical pedagogy.

Why this rating

- Telos reflects classical aims and uses Great Books, liberal-arts framing, and formation-based pedagogy. Yet the explicit documentation of core classical methods (e.g., repeated, explicit Socratic seminars, Scholé, chant/memorization methodologies in daily practice) is not consistently visible in the public-facing content. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL status on pedagogy rather than full CLASSICAL.

Citations

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Great Books/Great Conversation, classical framing:- Mission/formation emphasis with virtues:- Faculty as living curriculum and PD orientation:

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Faculty are described as classical educators who model virtue, love for children, and a deep commitment to students; there is emphasis on the faculty being the living curriculum and a collegial culture.
- The school highlights professional development, monthly trainings, formal reviews, and ongoing development plans for teachers, underscoring a culture of continuous improvement.
- There are explicit references to portraits of teacher norms and expectations as part of the school's vision; the faculty are presented as mentors and partners with students.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: living curriculum, model teachers, mentors, masters, collegial culture, portrait of a teacher, professional development, long-term planning, goal-setting.
- Negative keywords observed: none clearly present in public materials (no references to non-classical, non-mentor models).

Why this rating

- The faculty portrayal aligns strongly with classical expectations: teachers serve as exemplars of virtue and knowledge and function as the central, ongoing “living curriculum.” The explicit emphasis on ongoing PD and a cooperative culture reinforces the CLASSICAL designation.

Citations

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Faculty as living curriculum and PD emphasis:

Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes partnership with families as co-educators and formation of affections, with parents informed and involved in their children’s education. The concept of family involvement and a home-school partnership is repeatedly underscored.
- The admissions/application process highlights parent engagement and opportunities for ongoing parent involvement (informational sessions, openness to visits).
- The public materials discuss the importance of civics, family civics, and engagement with the broader community in a classical frame.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, family involvement, parental engagement, home-school connection, parental leadership.
- Negative keywords observed: consumer language or limited parent involvement; not evident in Telos materials.

Why this rating

- Telos presents a robust parental partnership model and community formation aligned with classical education norms (parents as co-educators, community engagement, and formation of affections). This is a strong CLASSICAL signal.

Citations

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Partnership with families and parent formation:- Admissions and parent engagement:

What Would Move the Needle

- No needle-moving changes are required given the CLASSICAL alignment across all six categories. If future refinement were desired, strengthening explicit, documented evidence of traditional pedagogy (e.g., documented use of Socratic seminars in upper grades, Scholé days, and structured memorization/chanting practices) could elevate Pedagogy from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL with greater certainty. Additional explicit articulation of Great Books-based sequences in daily schedules and more overt depiction of the Seven Liberal Arts (Trivium/Quadrivium) in mission statements or curricula pages would further solidify the classification.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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